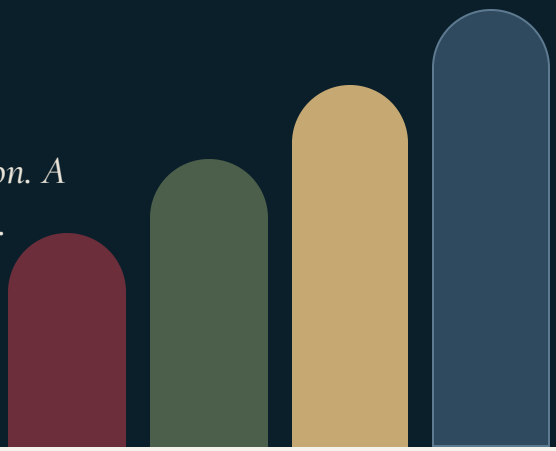
RPM LIVING · LEARNING EXPERIENCE DESIGNER CASE

The Art of the Tour

From showing spaces to creating connection. A learning experience for Leasing Associates.



Design brief for Luxury Living Co.
Brittany Blalock · November 2026

THE CHALLENGE

Tours are happening. Connection isn't.

Leadership sees four gaps in how Leasing Associates tour: weak connection, little personalization, flat amenity presentations, and unclear next steps. Associates already know their property. What's missing is the habit of learning what *this* prospect needs and building the whole tour around it. That makes this a **skill and judgment problem, not a knowledge problem**, and it shapes every decision below.

88%
of renters say a disorganized tour process changes their opinion of the property itself.
Rently renter survey, 2026

57%
still want a person available for questions, even though self-guided is the most popular first step (42%).
Rently renter survey, 2026

85% vs 40%
tour show rate when tours are booked within 3 days versus 7+ days out. Momentum after first contact matters.
Zuma, 1.5M multifamily tours

An MRI Software analysis of about 10,000 tours found that prospects with a personal interaction convert at higher rates. The associate is what turns a listing into a home.

Working assumptions

- Associates range from new hires to experienced agents, already trained on property details, the CRM, and Fair Housing.
- A typical tour runs 20 to 30 minutes; associates spend their day on their feet with a phone, not at a desk.
- Community managers are on site and can observe tours. The CRM logs tours, follow-ups, and outcomes.
- Some communities offer self-guided tours alongside agent-led ones.

1 · APPROACH

What learners need to do differently

The experience is built on the **coaching-to-decision sales model**: four steps in the order a tour actually happens, plus asking, which can happen at any time. Each observed gap maps to a step, and each step has a behavior a manager can see on a real tour.

> *"After The Art of the Tour, a Leasing Associate coaches each prospect to a decision: they build the relationship, understand the need, make a recommendation, and set up next steps, asking whenever the moment is right."*

RELATIONSHIP

Build the relationship. Gap: not building connection. Greets the prospect by name and uses one detail from their inquiry, then *frames to engage*: "I'd love to hear what you're looking for, show you the homes that fit, and save a few minutes for next steps. Sound good?"

NEED

Understand the need. Gap: missing personalization. Asks at least three open questions about the prospect's life, timing and decision (their routine, their move date, what else they're considering) before entering a home.

RECOMMEND

Make a recommendation. Gap: amenities not landing. Recommends a specific home and the two or three amenities that fit, and says why in the prospect's own words. "Based on your night shifts, I'd recommend 214. It's on the quiet side." Skips what doesn't matter to them.

NEXT STEPS

Set up next steps. Gap: unclear next steps and follow-up. Agrees on one specific next step with a day and time, confirms it out loud, and sends a personal follow-up within 24 hours.

ASK

Ask at any time. Asks for the decision whenever the prospect shows a buying signal, not only at the end. "You've said twice you love the quiet. Would you like me to hold it?" If the answer is "not yet," asks what it would take.

A guardrail built in: Fair Housing

Personalization must come from what the prospect chooses to share, never from assumptions about who they are. Every scenario models asking rather than assuming, offers the same information and incentives to every prospect, and the discovery question bank will be reviewed by compliance before launch.

2 · DESIGN DECISIONS

Why this approach and format

Practice over presentation

Because associates already know the content, roughly 70% of learner time is spent deciding, practicing, and getting feedback. A **branching scenario** fits because a tour is a live conversation where every choice changes how the prospect feels.

The sales model they already use

Building on coaching-to-decision means associates and managers use one language for selling, training and coaching. The training shows what each step looks like on a tour, and treats asking as a habit, not a final step.

Personas, not scripts

Personalization is the skill, so learners tour different prospects whose needs pull the tour in different directions. The same "right" move for one is a miss for another.

Mobile-first, in the flow of work

Associates work on their feet between walk-ins and calls. Instead of a desktop course, The Art of the Tour is a **mobile web app** (prototyped in Lovable) with 5 to 15 minute pieces. The app the learner trains in is also the job aid they open in the parking lot before the next tour.

Respect for experienced adults

Experienced agents can start with the scenario as a pre-check and skip ahead. Feedback names what happened and why, through the prospect's eyes, rather than right/wrong scoring.

A hospitality brand

"The Art of the Tour" (midnight navy, antique gold, warm parchment) frames touring as a craft associates grow in. It respects experienced agents and keeps the experience on-brand for a luxury company.

THE LEARNING JOURNEY

From first look to everyday habit

About two weeks of core learning, then 30 days of reinforcement. Managers start first so they can coach in the same language.

EXPERIENCE	MODALITY	TIME	WHAT IT DOES
The Concierge Briefing	Manager guide + 20-min call	Week 0	Managers learn the model, the observation checklist, and how to coach before their teams begin.
Two Tours	Video microlearning	6 min	The same tour shown twice, flat and then personalized, narrated by the prospect's inner thoughts. Learners spot what changed. Builds the "why."
The Model	In-app overview	5 min	Introduces the coaching-to-decision model, each step with one behavior and one example, and "ask at any time."
Rehearsal	Branching scenario	2 × 15 min	Learners tour two personas with different needs. Choices move a Connection Meter; feedback shows the prospect's reaction. One decision is a buying signal to practice asking mid-tour. A debrief scores each step.

EXPERIENCE	MODALITY	TIME	WHAT IT DOES
Practice Partner STRETCH	AI role-play	10 min	Learners type or speak responses to a simulated prospect and get step-by-step coaching. Piloted only if reliable.
Your Key Card	Mobile job aid	On demand	The model, a frame-to-engage opener, a discovery question bank, recommendation starters, asking lines and follow-up message starters.
Live Rehearsal	Peer role-play	30 min	In a team meeting, pairs tour each other using persona cards; an observer uses the checklist.
Opening Night	Observed real tour	Week 2	The manager shadows one live tour with the Concierge checklist, then gives 10 minutes of coaching.
Encore	Spaced nudges	Days 3–30	Short scenario questions, a "tour win" share in the team channel, and a 30-day re-observation.

3 · BEYOND THE EXPERIENCE

What makes it stick on the property

Manager support

- **Concierge checklist**: each step of the model plus asking, a 1 to 3 rating, and one coaching note per observed tour.
- A 15-minute huddle guide for team meetings.
- Coaching prompts that ask before telling: "What did you learn about her in the first two minutes?"

Ongoing practice

- A monthly "tour of the month" peer role-play using a new persona.
- Optional self-recorded mock tour with a reflection checklist.
- New personas added each quarter from real tour situations.

Reinforcement

- Spaced scenario questions at days 3, 7, 14, and 30.
- A "tour of the week" moment shared by managers in the team channel.
- The Art of the Tour added to the new-hire leasing onboarding path.

Fix the process, not just the person

Some of the follow-up gap may not be a skill gap. I'd recommend an automatic CRM task after every logged tour, due in 24 hours, with message templates that prompt for one personal detail. Training plus a simple system nudge beats training alone.

4 · MEASUREMENT

How we'll know it worked

Pilot at a handful of communities, compare them with similar communities that haven't started yet, and set a 90-day baseline before launch so we can separate the training's impact from seasonality.

LEVEL	WHAT WE MEASURE	SOURCE
Reaction	Relevance and confidence: "I can use this on my next tour." Tour Pulse confidence items repeated at 90 days.	Two-question in-app pulse
Learning	Scenario performance on each step, pre-check vs. final; which steps learners struggle with most.	App decision data
Behavior	Manager observation scores on every step, including asking, at 30, 60, and 90 days. Share of tours with a personalized follow-up logged within 24 hours.	Concierge checklist, CRM, mystery shops
Results	Tour-to-application and tour-to-lease conversion. Prospect post-tour survey: "I felt understood" and "I know my next step." Online reviews that mention associates by name.	CRM, survey, review monitoring

Leading indicator to watch first: follow-up within 24 hours, because it moves quickly and is easy to see. Conversion is the lagging indicator leadership cares about most.

5 · NEXT STEPS

What I'd want to learn and validate

Validate the gap

- Send the **Tour Pulse** survey to associates: confidence on each step of the model, barriers, and how they want to learn. It becomes the 90-day baseline.
- Shadow 8 to 10 tours and listen to recorded ones across strong and struggling communities.
- Interview top-performing associates: what do they do in the first two minutes that others don't?
- Pull CRM data on follow-up timing and conversion by associate to size the problem.

Review with SMEs

- Compliance review of every scenario and the discovery question bank.
- Leasing leaders confirm personas and "what great looks like."

Test with learners

- Run the scenario prototype with 3 to 5 associates for realism and usability on a phone.
- Have 2 to 3 managers trial the checklist on live tours.

Develop further

- A self-guided tour module: how to create connection when the prospect tours alone.
- More personas, a Spanish-language version and a guarded AI role-play pilot.
- A 90-day pilot across 3 to 5 communities, then scale.

From showing spaces to creating connection.

SOURCES · Rently renter survey (800 U.S. renters), June 2026, via GlobeNewswire · Zuma, *Multifamily Tour Conversion Report* (1.5M tours, 1,000+ properties), getzuma.com · MRI Software, "Apartment leasing tours perform better with a personal touch," Oct 2020, mrisoftware.com. Luxury Living Co. is the fictional company from the case prompt; assumptions would be validated with real learners and SMEs.